

Nielsen Norman Group **Heuristic Evaluation Workbook**

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

EVALUATOR:

DATE:

PRODUCT:

TASK:

and System Settings

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

Both screens utilize a large blue action button ("Save Changes" and "Save Settings"). When a user taps these, there is no immediate UI state showing that the system has successfully received, processed, and locked in that data.

Recommendations

During submission: Temporarily transition the button text to a loading spinner if the network request takes more than 1 second. To Trigger a brief, floating Success Toast Notification at the top or bottom of the screen (example "ÿ Settings saved successfully"), or visually return them to the previous page with the updated data immediately visible.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

On the Business Hours screen, the active days are laid out horizontally as [M] [T] [W] [T] [F] [S] [S]. While this fits a compact mobile screen, it can create mild friction because "T" and "S" are repeated. Furthermore, in many regions, the calendar week conventionally begins on Sunday rather than Monday.

Recommendations

If the target audience considers Sunday the start of the week, rearrange the blocks to [S] [M] [T] [W] [T] [F] [S]. To maximize clarity and prevent error, you can also use slightly distinct letter labels or tooltips if space permits (e.g., Th for Thursday, Sa for Saturday, Su for Sunday).

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3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

On heavy data-entry forms like Edit User Profile or Assign Category, clicking the "Back" arrow or "Cancel" button instantly destroys any text the user just typed. If a user accidentally taps back while typing their email or note, they have no way to recover that lost data.

Recommendations

Implement a Confirmation Modal an exit confirmation dialog if a user attempts to navigate away from a form with unsaved changes.

Example popup: "Discard changes? You have unsaved changes that will be lost." $\rightarrow$ Choices: [Keep Editing] or [Discard].

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

On the Edit User Profile screen, the secondary exit action is a clear text link reading "Cancel" centered below the primary button. However, on other data entry layouts (like Assign Category), the secondary action is placed side-by-side with the primary button as a "Back" button. This forces users to learn two different layout systems for saving/abandoning form data.

Recommendations

Standardize your form completion buttons. If you use a side-by-side button layout (e.g., [Cancel] [Save Changes]), apply it uniformly across all modal and editing screens rather than switching between stacked and horizontal variations.

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5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

On the Notifications screen, switching off a critical element like "Business activity alerts" happens instantly with a single tap. If this alert is vital for their operations, disabling it accidentally without a warning could cause them to miss high-priority system events.

Recommendations

For high-impact settings, introduce a confirmation constraint. While low-risk notifications can toggle freely, turning off a critical alert tier should trigger a quick confirmation prompt: "Are you sure you want to turn off Business Activity Alerts? You may miss real-time transaction updates."

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

On the Business Hours configuration page, empty time slots read "Start time" and "End time". If the text input is unconstrained, there is no contextual tip showing what format the system requires. Users have to guess whether they should type 09:00, 9:00 AM, or 21:00.

Recommendations

Add explicit contextual tooltips or inline mask examples right below or inside the empty input box.

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Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

On the Category | Settings screen, the list shows stock options like "Food & Dining" and "Transport." If a user runs a highly niche business, these generic presets might not fit their actual daily workflows. Forced adherence to a rigid, hardcoded list reduces efficiency.

Recommendations

Allow users to build Custom Shortcuts or Rules. Add an "[+ Create Custom Category]" button to the layout, and let power users map automated triggers.

Example feature: "Always map transactions containing the word 'Uber' to the 'Transport' category automatically."

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

On the Settings menu rows, your main labels read: "Business Hours Settings", "Notification Settings", and "Category Management". Because these items live directly inside a container explicitly titled "Settings" at the top of the screen, repeating the word "Settings" on every single row is redundant and adds unnecessary visual noise.

Recommendations

Strip the redundant text to optimize scannability. Shorten the menu items to:

Business Hours
Notifications
Category Management

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9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

Standard error messages often use developer-centric validation text or vague statements (e.g., "Submission failed" or "Invalid input"). This tells the user that an error occurred, but fails to diagnose the actual problem.

Recommendations

Write constructive, plain-language error copy that tells the user exactly how to fix the issue.
Use: "Please enter a valid 10-digit phone number (e.g., 0912345678)."

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

The primary Settings landing page contains technical configurations (Language, Theme, Notification channels), but there is no overarching "Help Center," or "Support" link visible. If a user experiences an internal error or has a question not answered by a 1-line subtitle, they are entirely marooned.

Recommendations

Build an explicit, highly discoverable escape hatch for documentation:
Place a dedicated "Help & Support" list option directly onto your Settings page (ideally near the bottom under a general or account section).